

Syllabus for ECE 39401 – Fall 2023 – 1 credit
Professional Communications and Diversity (CRN 25293)

Class Meetings: Tuesdays, 9:30-10:20 AM, WALC 1087, Instructional Modality: Face-to-Face

(NOTE: Syllabus is subject to change. The version on Brightspace is always the most current version.)

Contact Information:
Instructor: Prof. Brent Jesiek
E-mail: bjesiek@purdue.edu
Office Phone: (765) 496-1531
Physical Office: ARMS 1313
Office Hours: Tuesdays, 12:30-2:30 PM (ARMS 1313 and Zoom) and by appointment
Zoom meeting link for office hours: https://purdue-edu.zoom.us/my/bjesiek

Course Description:
(From Purdue Catalog) This course provides ECE students with practice in relevant aspects of communication. Topics include: successfully seeking employment, working effectively in teams, delivering engaging presentations, and leveraging the advantages and challenges of diversity and inclusion.

(Instructor's Appendum) The goal of this course is to practice vital communication skills that will serve you well in your careers and lives. By the end of this course, you should feel much more comfortable creating inclusive environments that encourage the success of all members, making wise decisions that positively impact your long-term health, articulating and leveraging your strengths and weakness (including in interviews and application materials), and creating presentations that wrestle with the complexity of engineering challenges.

Learning Outcomes:
1. An ability to function effectively on a team whose members together provide leadership, create a collaborative and inclusive environment, establish goals, plan tasks, and meet objectives
2. An ability to communicate effectively with a range of audiences
3. An ability to apply engineering design to produce solutions that meet specified needs with consideration of public health, safety, and welfare, as well as global, cultural, social, environmental, and economic factors

About your Instructor:
I'm Brent Jesiek, Professor in Engineering Education and Electrical and Computer Engineering. I am an engineer turned social scientist, and love having opportunities to help students develop professional skills, from programming and data analysis to global competency, ethics, communication, and "boundary spanning." I like to read novels, listen to indie rock music, and get outside for mountain biking, snowboarding, and paddleboard surfing. (And yes, you can surf on Lake Michigan!) I look forward to getting to know many of you this semester – please reach out and connect.

Brightspace Course Site:
You can access the course via Brightspace. I strongly encourage you to spend some time at the start of this course to become familiar with the site navigation, content, and resources available to you throughout the Brightspace site. There will be lots of important info there throughout the semester! (See the Help tab, if needed.)

Minimum technology requirements

- You will need a stable, reliable Internet connection on a regular basis to meet the requirements for this class.
- It is NOT recommended that students attempt to complete this course using only a mobile phone.
- This course will utilize video, which will require more data if using a mobile device.
- Students must be able to use Brightspace and all of its features to be successful in this course.

Typical Weekly Workload and Expectations:

- ~10-15 pages of reading
- 1-2 pre-lecture videos
- 2-3 content quizzes
- Work on longer-term assignments
- Weekly class meetings
- Group notes

Typical Weekly Due Dates:

- Before class: content quizzes
- During class: attendance quizzes
- At the end of class: group notes

Course Grade Structure:

- Individual work (50%):
  - Content Quizzes – 15% of grade
  - Attendance Quizzes – 15% of grade
  - Cultural Exchange (Participant Write-up) – 10% of grade
  - Cultural Exchange (Guide Write-up) – 10% of grade
- Group work (50%):
  - Group Notes – 20% of grade
  - Group Presentation – 20% of grade
  - Group Reflection – 10% of grade

Grading Scale:

100-93%: A	89-87%: B+	79-77%: C+	69-67%: D+	<60%: F
92-90%: A-	86-83%: B	76-73%: C	66-63%: D	
	82-80%: B-	72-70%: C-	62-60%: D-	

Attendance Policy:
You may miss one class with no penalty. After that, you'll lose attendance points, unless it is a University-excused absence. I will also offer an opportunity for extra credit toward the end of the semester to make up for one additional absence. In cases falling under excused absence regulations, the student or the student's representative should contact or go to the Office of the Dean of Students (ODOS) website to complete appropriate forms for instructor notification. Under academic regulations, excused absences may be granted **by ODOS** for cases of grief/bereavement, military service, jury duty, parenting leave, or emergent or urgent care medical care.

Assignments:

- *Content Quizzes:* Each week, you'll have one or more pre-class quizzes over the content covered. These quizzes aren't meant to trick you; they're meant to check for comprehension and engagement. Sometimes there is an activity you need to complete before the quiz. Be sure to do that.
- *Attendance Quizzes:* At some point during each class session, I'll open a quick attendance quiz and everyone who is in class will complete it at that time.
- *Cultural Exchange Project:* We will talk more about this in class, but I will tell you that it's usually the assignment that students are most nervous about, but end up liking the best.
- *Group Notes:* At the end of many classes, you will turn in specific notes about what your group did during that session. You'll have a clear structure for these, and they're meant to make sure your group is making consistent progress and documenting your work.
- *Group Presentation*: In your teams/groups, you will create a 10-12 minute presentation for the class on a current engineering issue. Many more details will be shared in class. Your presentation will:
    - Briefly explain the issue (background info so we're all on the same page),
    - Elaborate on the different considerations at play with this issue (areas to cover: ethical, cultural, environmental, economic, public health/safety),
    - Explain where your team stands on the issue and why (this might include suggestions for solutions or paths forward),
    - Post questions and considerations for further discussion, and
    - Include a visual aid (power point, demonstration, etc.).
- *Group Reflection:* You'll receive feedback from me and every student in the class. After digesting that feedback, you'll reflect as a group on your successes and areas for improvement.

Late work/make-up work:
Content quizzes, attendance quizzes, and group notes will NOT be accepted late. Cultural Exchange Write-ups and Group Reflections will be accepted late, but will be docked 10% for each day late.

Academic Integrity:
Academic integrity is one of the highest values that Purdue University holds. Individuals are encouraged to alert university officials to potential breaches of this value by either emailing integrity@purdue.edu or by calling 765-494-8778. While information may be submitted anonymously, the more information is submitted the greater the opportunity for the university to investigate the concern. More details are available on our course Brightspace under University Policies.

Policy on Artificial Intelligence and Large Language Models:
Students who use AI-generated writing for any portion of their written assignments will be deemed in violation of the academic integrity expectations for this course. Violations can include a failing grade on an assignment, failing grade in the course, and restrictions from further class participation. All suspected incidents of academic dishonesty will also be referred to the Office of Student Rights and Responsibilities for further review of the student's status with the University, which may include being separated from the University.

Using AI tools to help with such things as idea generation or planning your work *may be* appropriate uses of AI/LLM tools, though your context and the nature of the assignment must be considered. Also, keep in mind that words and ideas generated by some AI tools make use of other, human authors' ideas without referencing them, which, as things stand, is controversial in itself and can be viewed as a form a plagiarism. *If you decide to use AI tools for any aspect of any graded work in this class, you must disclose such use with a brief acknowledgement and explanation, e.g.:*

I acknowledge the use of ChatGPT (https://chat.openai.com/) to plan my essay, and generate some initial ideas which I used in background research and self-study in the drafting of this assessment.

Adapted from: https://www.ucl.ac.uk/students/exams-and-assessments/assessment-success-guide/engaging-ai-your-education-and-assessment

Purdue's Honor Pledge:
"As a boilermaker pursuing academic excellence, I pledge to be honest and true in all that I do. Accountable together — we are Purdue."

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Statement:
In this class, discussions, collaboration, and feedback will be an integral part of each week's class activities and learning. Respect for each other as people and professionals is, of course, expected. I'm excited to see how we can all learn from each other and make connections we may have missed otherwise. A few points worth noting:

- We are all in the process of learning about others and their experiences. Please speak with me if something has made you uncomfortable.
- Intention and impact are not always aligned, and we should respect the impact something may have on someone even if it was not the speaker's intention.
- We all come to the class with a variety of experiences and a range of expertise, we should respect these in others while critically examining them in ourselves.

Nondiscrimination Statement:
Purdue University is committed to maintaining a community that recognizes and values the inherent worth and dignity of every person; fosters tolerance, sensitivity, understanding, and mutual respect among its members; and encourages each individual to strive to reach his or her potential. In pursuit of its goal of academic excellence, the University seeks to develop and nurture diversity. The University believes that diversity among its many members strengthens the institution, stimulates creativity, promotes the exchange of ideas, and enriches campus life. A hyperlink to Purdue's full Nondiscrimination Policy Statement is included in our course Brightspace under University Policies.

Mental Health/Wellness Statement:

- **If you find yourself beginning to feel some stress, anxiety and/or feeling slightly overwhelmed, try** WellTrack**.** Sign in and find information and tools at your fingertips, available to you at any time.
- **If you need support and information about options and resources**, please contact or see the Office of the Dean of Students. Call 765-494-1747. Hours of operation are M-F, 8 am- 5 pm.
- **If you find yourself struggling to find a healthy balance between academics, social life, stress**, etc., sign up for free one-on-one virtual or in-person sessions with a Purdue Wellness Coach at RecWell. Student coaches can help you navigate through barriers and challenges toward your goals throughout the semester. Sign up is free and can be done on BoilerConnect.
- **If you're struggling and need mental health services: Purdue University is committed to advancing the mental health and well-being of its students.** If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of mental health support, services are available. For help, such individuals should contact Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) at 765-494-6995 during and after hours, on weekends and holidays, or by going to the CAPS office on the second floor of the Purdue University Student Health Center (PUSH) during business hours. The CAPS website also offers resources specific to situations such as COVID-19.

Engineering-Specific Option: TaskHuman
TaskHuman offers 1-on-1 live video calls with coaches who help you focus on wellness topics such as anxiety, mindfulness, reducing stress, clean eating, time management, in-home workouts, relationship tensions, and nearly a thousand more topics. You can log on at any time to access experiences as diverse as working through heightened anxiety to a personalized yoga session with carefully vetted providers.

Purdue Engineering has an exclusive agreement with TaskHuman which gives you unlimited access to these resources (and some Purdue-specific bonuses, including mentoring by industry leaders!). Using this link gets you access to all the perks: **https://taskhuman.com/referral/purdue**

Basic Needs Security:
Any student who faces challenges securing their food or housing and believes this may affect their performance in the course is urged to contact the Dean of Students for support. There is no appointment needed and Student Support Services is available to serve students 8 AM to 5 PM, Monday through Friday.

Emergency Preparation:
In the event of a major campus emergency, course requirements, deadlines and grading percentages are subject to changes that may be necessitated by a revised semester calendar or other circumstances beyond the instructor's control. Relevant changes to this course will be posted onto the course website or can be obtained by contacting the instructors or TAs via email or phone. You are expected to read your @purdue.edu email on a frequent basis.

Accessibility statement:
Ensuring that Purdue students have access to equitable learning experiences is a University-level commitment and is the responsibility of all members of the Purdue community. The Disability Resource Center (DRC) is a key partner in this work and is a resource for students and instructors.

The Student Services widget links to the DRC. Your syllabus or Brightspace Start Here may address your personal policy for making the learning experiences in your course as accessible as possible. The DRC website provides a sample syllabus statement as well as other Instructor Resources such as the Usable Materials Center. You are also encouraged to contact the Disability Resource Center at: drc@purdue.edu or by phone: 765-494-1247.

Sample Schedule

(Subject to change with appropriate notice.)
Due before class: Content quizzes and other pre-class work
Due during class: Attendance quiz
Due at end of designated class sessions: Group notes

Week (Date)	Topic	Watch/Read/Do/Due before class	In class
Week 1 (8/22)	Welcome Introductions	Syllabus	Intro Ice breakers Group formation Due in class: Attendance quiz
Week 2 (8/29)	Vulnerability Empathy	CATME Team Formation Survey (8/27) TBD – Pre-class content TBD – Pre-class activity (if assigned) TBD – Pre-class quiz	Introduce Presentation Assignment Group discussion: Vulnerability/Empathy Due in class: Attendance quiz Due at end of class: Group notes
NOTE: An updated schedule will be posted to Brightspace during the first week or two of class.			